

Autocomplete Poetry Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and Technology • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and Technology	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	autocomplete-poetry

Big idea: Prediction can imitate creativity.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Students write a poem using only suggested next words from a shared prompt. Rank, sort, or audit this output. Identify which rule, ranking signal, or interface choice shaped your judgement.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Two poems compared: one written by intention, one guided by autocomplete. Rank, sort, or audit this output. Identify which rule, ranking signal, or interface choice shaped your judgement.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Autocomplete Poetry Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A reflection on whether fluency signals authorship or knowledge. Rank, sort, or audit this output. Identify which rule, ranking signal, or interface choice shaped your judgement.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Prediction can imitate creativity.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Autocomplete Poetry Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	Does pattern prediction count as understanding?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Students write a poem using only suggested next words from a shared prompt.
- Two poems compared: one written by intention, one guided by autocomplete.
- A reflection on whether fluency signals authorship or knowledge.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and Technology.

Activity Steps

1. Students write the first line of a poem or reflection.
2. They use autocomplete to continue it for six to ten lines.
3. Compare the result with a human-written continuation.
4. Students annotate where the machine is patterned, surprising, empty or meaningful.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: Does pattern prediction count as understanding?
- Can creativity exist without intention?
- How does technology change authorship?

Knowledge Questions

- Does pattern prediction count as understanding?
- Can creativity exist without intention?
- How does technology change authorship?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with students write a poem using only suggested next words from a shared prompt. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...